

New kings, old fire

As divisions shift and legacies are tested, UFC 324 and 325 pit emerging contenders against proven champions in a **defining** early-season stretch.

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The Ultimate Fighting Championship (UFC) will kick off the new year with a blockbuster start, featuring two highly anticipated numbered events: UFC 324 on January 25 and UFC 325 on February 1.

The UFC 324 card in Las Vegas represents a pivotal moment for the lightweight and bantamweight divisions, headlined by two bouts

that pit established legends against breakout talent.

Islam Makhachev's decision to relinquish his lightweight belt and move up to the welterweight division has opened up new avenues in the weight class. In the main event, Justin Gaethje takes on Paddy Pimblett for the interim lightweight belt, a matchup defined by the clash between seasoned grit and youthful ambition.

Gaethje, long considered the gold

standard for structural damage, is likely to employ a strategy centred on his signature low calf kicks offensively, while utilising a high guard defensively.

His objective will be to keep Pimblett constantly moving and force a technical boxing exchange, leveraging his superior power to exploit Pimblett's historical tendency to leave his chin exposed during high-volume exchanges.

However, the tactical narrative

